SAMURAI EDGE

BAKUMATSU COMBAT CHRONICLES — TWILIGHT OF STEEL

OFFICIAL INSTRUCTION MANUAL & STRATEGY GUIDE

CONDENSED UNIFIED EDITION: 24 WARRIORS & 24 HOME ARENAS

HISTORICAL ARCHIVE & DIEGETIC DUEL COMBAT DOCTRINE

EDO • KYOTO • IGA • NAGASAKI (1860–1868)

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METHODICAL COMPENDIUM STRUCTURE

• High-Density Unified Dossiers (Pages 07–18): Each page unites two fighters alongside their home arenas, presenting concise lore, canonical metrics, and soil dynamics.

• Strict Visual Proportions: Fighter combat portraits (3:4) and widescreen arena previews (16:9) are strictly scaled to their native aspect ratios without distortion.

• Engine Ground Truth: Vitality metrics (3 HP for Musashi and Raiden, 2 HP for all other 22 fighters), velocities (m/s), and ring-out pit counts match engine source code.

MARTIAL CONVENTIONS & SYMBOLOGY

• Universal Diegetic Inputs: Primary Attack [E], Special Action [R], Dedicated Roll [T], and Guard [F] form the core instant-response foundation for all 24 combat styles.

• Sudden Death Lethality: No inflated health bars. The first clean strike landed during counter-attack or whiffed recovery seals the outcome of the clash.

• Blade Clash QTE: Symmetric blade collision on the exact same frame triggers real-time rapid-mash contest, inflicting 24 frames of off-balance stagger upon the loser.

«The wise warrior studies both the ground and the blade before drawing steel in the opening clash.»

THE LEGEND OF BAKUMATSU & THE ASH SEAL

TWILIGHT OF THE SHOGUNATE & THE BLOOD PROPHECY

1. The End of Two Centuries of Peace (Sakoku)

In the twilight of the 19th century (1860s), Japan was violently shaken by the sudden arrival of Commodore Perry's 'Black Ships', abruptly shattering over two centuries of sacred isolation (Sakoku). The land of the rising sun fractured into a savage, merciless civil war: on one side stood the Tokugawa Shogunate loyalists fighting to preserve feudal order and the samurai caste; on the other, rebel imperialists from Choshu and Satsuma demanding supreme imperial restoration.

2. The Slumbering Titan in the Shadow Cave

Yet beneath the veil of political assassinations and the relentless advance of Western firearms, a far more terrifying primordial nightmare stirred. In the impenetrable, mist-shrouded peaks of Iga Province, within the eternal dark of the Shadow Cave, lay sealed for over a millennium the Oni Gashadokuro: a colossal skeletal titan forged from the collective malice and despair of tens of thousands of warriors slain in ancient wars and abandoned without burial.

3. The Conspiracy of the Awakening

Ancient Onmyodo prophecy foretold that should Japan's soil once again become saturated with the spilled blood of unsettled souls, the divine shimenawa cords binding the colossus would shatter. Unwittingly, every clash of steel across burning Kyoto streets, every ambush in bamboo thickets, and every duel on rain-slicked Dejima wharves feeds this awakening darkness, hastening the titan's return to extinguish all life across the four islands of Japan.

4. The Moral Dilemma of Steel (Katsujinken vs Setsuninto)

While political warlords scheme behind guarded shoji screens, highways and terraced rice paddies have turned into hunting grounds for masterless ronin, clandestine alchemists, and wandering swordsmen. The fate of the nation no longer rests upon diplomatic treaties sealed in ink: it will be carved by the razor edge of drawn steel.

5. The Point of No Return in the Twilight of 1863

Only those who conquer the fear of mortality and master the razor-thin fraction of a second between a lethal draw and the void of a whiffed strike will reach the heart of the Iga mountains, deciding whether Japan will rise into a new dawn of honor or be swallowed whole by the titan of ash and iron.

CHRONICLE OF THE TWILIGHT & THE FATE OF IGA

The spilled blood across Kyoto, Iga, Ezo, and Nagasaki serves as the spiritual catalyst shattering the ancient iron seal of the Oni Gashadokuro. Only the life-giving sword (Katsujinken) holds the virtue to purify the ashes of feudal Japan.

«Upon the razor's edge, between the draw and the cleave, there is no room for hatred: only the naked truth of steel.
He who wavers before the mists of Iga already rests beneath the earth with the ancestors.»

THE SEVEN WARRING FACTIONS

ALLIANCES, LOYALTIES & BLOOD MOTIVATIONS

1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

Swordsmen, archers, monks, and rebellious peasants who took up arms not for political dominion, but to defend helpless villages, shrines, and innocents against the carnage and pillaging of civil war.
Members: Kenshi, Tomoe, Daiki, Goro, Benkei | Philosophy: The life-giving sword (Katsujinken). Defending the defenseless against feudal tyranny and the rampaging violence of warlords.

2. Duelists of the Pinnacle & Glory Seekers

Legendary martial artists who view the turbulence of the Bakumatsu as the ultimate crucible to test their physical and spiritual limits against the deadliest fighters alive.
Members: Musashi, Ren, Raiden | Philosophy: Uncompromising pursuit of supreme martial mastery, where every blade duel is an intimate dialogue with mortality itself.

3. Loyalists & Keepers of the Order

Disciplined soldiers bound by unshakable oaths of allegiance to their commanders, the Shogunate, the Emperor, or foreign sovereign crowns.
Members: Saitou, Julie, Ichi | Philosophy: Absolute duty, martial honor, and blind loyalty to the banner they swore to protect until their dying breath.

4. Opportunists & Scientists of Chaos

Eccentric scholars, eldritch necromancers, and mystic dancers operating within the shadows of war, exploiting spilled blood to conduct forbidden experiments and harness occult power.
Members: Hendrika, Valerius, Okuni | Philosophy: Chaos is fertile soil. Traditional morality is cast aside in favor of empirical alchemical breakthrough and spiritual harvest.

5. Mercenaries & Privateers of War

Guns for hire and audacious seafarers navigating maritime trade and feudal strife in relentless pursuit of gold, black powder, and unbridled freedom.
Members: Anne, Teppo | Philosophy: Survival, gold, and sovereignty. Fighting for the highest bidder or their own loyal crew without fealty to feudal lords.

6. Guardians of the Seal (Iga Shinobi Clan)

The shadow elite of Iga. Feared as ruthless assassins by the outside world, they are in truth the clandestine vanguard guarding the Shadow Cave to prevent the slumbering Oni Gashadokuro from rising.
Members: Hanzo, Kasumi, Murasaki, Chiyo | Philosophy: Invisible sacrifice. Preserving the ancient seal even if history forever condemns them as cruel monsters.

7. The Temporal Traveler & Unlikely Ally

A 21st-century US Marine tactical operator and anime enthusiast accidentally hurled back in time to 1863 following a catastrophic classified government wormhole experiment.
Members: Joe | Philosophy: Survival via high-speed tactical modern ninjutsu. Upon witnessing the noble duty of the Iga clan, he swore to stand beside them with his faithful war hound Yamato.

Alliance Dynamics & Coalitions in Arcade Mode

Coalition	Aligned Factions	Stance on the Titan Awakening
Guardian Alliance	Protectors of the People & Temporal Ally (Joe)	Join forces with the Iga shinobi to stem bloodshed and shield defenseless villagers.
Shadow Seal	Iga Guardians (Hanzo, Kasumi, Murasaki, Chiyo)	Absolute sacrifice: defend the Shadow Cave to the death against any and all intruders.
Duelists of Honor	Duelists of the Pinnacle, Loyalists & Mercenaries	Fight for honor or oaths; upon witnessing the Oni arise, unite their steel to save the realm.
Occult Harvesters	Opportunists & Scientists of Chaos	Seek to catalyze alchemical miasmas and harvest eldritch relics fueled by the slaughter.

Canonical Rivalry Matrix & Historic Clashes

- Kenshi vs Saitou: The supreme ideological duel between the Protector of Innocents and the Shinsengumi Wolf across Kyoto.
- Hanzo vs Joe: The clash of doctrines between the feudal Ninjutsu master and the modern tactical operator with Yamato.
- Musashi vs Benkei: Monumental clash pitting the virtuosity of Dual Blades against the crushing weight of the Kanabo on Gojo Bridge.
- Hendrika vs Seimei: The epistemological duel between Western chemical science at Dejima and the cosmic mysticism of Onmyodo.

«Each warrior's path through Arcade Mode reflects their allegiance: while the Protectors strive to pacify warring provinces, the Opportunists scheme to harness the dark power of the Shadow Cave for their own forbidden alchemy.»

BASIC CONTROLS & DUEL SYSTEM

DIEGETIC CONTROL SYSTEM & SINGLE-BLADE LETHALITY

Samurai Edge employs an isometric diegetic combat system inspired by the timeless cinema of Akira Kurosawa and the uncompromising surgical precision of Bushido Blade. Every slash carries lethal consequence and rigorous 3D spatial alignment.

Martial Action	Universal Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Tactical Effect
8-Way Movement	D-Pad / Left Analog Stick	[W, A, S, D] (P1) / [Arrows] (P2)	Tactical 3D positioning and distance management across the arena floor
Primary Attack	Button X / Square	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Signature weapon strike (rapid draw Battojutsu, cleave, thrust, or gunshot)
Secondary / Special Action	Button Y / Triangle	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Fighter-specific special maneuver, acrobatics, projectile, or reactive parry
Dedicated Roll / Dash	Button B / Circle	[T] (P1) / [O] (P2)	High-speed evasive roll with 12 frames of invulnerability
Universal Guard / Parry	Button RB / R1	[F] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Defensive stance with active parry deflection window against enemy slashes
Pause / Ceremonial Menu	Start / Options Button	[ESC]	Parchment Sumi-E menu pause and real-time moveset inspection

Core Dueling Mechanics:

• Blade Clash QTE: When two symmetric slashes connect within the exact same spatial frame, the duel freezes for 600ms amidst blinding sparks. The duelist who mashes the primary attack button faster overpowers the lock, staggering their foe with 24 frames of off-balance stun.

• Absolute Precedence: Certain attacks (such as Murasaki's Kusarigama scythe sweep and Hendrika's piercing corrosive rapier) possess hardcoded mathematical priority, cleanly cutting through clashes and interrupting ordinary slashes.

• Guard Crush: Heavy blank artillery discharges (Teppo), spiked iron club smashes (Benkei), and alchemical acid thrusts (Hendrika) shatter active parry stances, inflicting heavy daze upon defending opponents.

• Surgical Lethality (1 to 3 HP): Almost all fighters possess 2 Hit Points (with the sole exceptions of Musashi and Raiden, who possess 3 HP). A single clean counter-hit delivered during an enemy's whiffed recovery decides the duel instantly.

Anatomy of the Blade Clash QTE:
When two symmetric slashes connect on the exact same frame, time slows down for 600ms amid dazzling sparks. Both duelists enter a rapid mash contest: the fighter recording the higher primary attack tap frequency overpowers the bind, inflicting 24 frames of off-balance stagger upon the loser, leaving them defenseless.

Invulnerability & 3D Attack Trajectories:
The dedicated roll [T] grants 12 frames of invulnerability against horizontal slashes, arrows, gunfire, and spells. However, downward strikes plunging into the floor (such as Raiden's stomp or Kenshi's Ryuu Tsui-Sen dive) ignore roll frames and strike prone targets, severely punishing panic evasions.

ADVANCED MARTIAL EXECUTION DIRECTIVES

• Moving Draw: Pressing Attack [E] while tilting the directional stick lunges forward by 0.85 meters.
• Evasive Cancel: The dedicated roll [T] cancels initial sprint frames and slow startup swings for rapid repositioning.
• Active Parry Window: The guard stance [F] lasts 14 frames; whiffing a parry imposes an 18-frame punishable recovery lag.
• Feint Cancellation: Tapping Guard [F] during attack [E] startup feints the strike, baiting defensive whiffs.
• Tech Roll Recovery: Pressing [T] at the exact instant of knockdown cancels ground lag and immediately restores combat poise.

COMBAT MODES & TOURNAMENT PRELUDE

THE LADDER OF DESTINY & DIEGETIC DUEL PHILOSOPHY

ARCADE MODE — THE 12-FIGHT GAUNTLET

The definitive solo campaign. The player selects their warrior and journeys through an escalating ladder of 12 ritual duels where spilled blood resonates across the four islands of Japan, systematically destabilizing the sacred seal of the Shadow Cave:

Act / Stage	Adversaries & Provinces	Rules & Victory Condition
Act I: Ranked Duels 1 to 4	Classic Best-of-3 (BO3) duels against introductory challengers drawn democratically across initial roster tiers.	Eliminação direta
Act II: Trial of the Masters 5 to 8	High-tension tactical encounters against veteran masters, archers, and exotic weapon specialists across treacherous battlefields.	Eliminação direta
Act III: The Mirror Duel (Fight 9)	The warrior faces their own spectral shadow within their home arena	A battle of nerves and pure technique under identical weapon parameters.
Act IV: Endurance Gauntlet (Fight 10)	Two elite adversaries in unbroken succession, sharing the player's round life pool	Demands strict spatial awareness and poise.
Act V: The Shadow Gate (Fight 11)	Entering the subterranean depths of Mount Suzuka	The player must defeat the Iga Guardian phalanx (Joe, Kasumi, Murasaki, Hanzo, and Chiyo) under toxic fumes.
Epilogue: The Titan Awakens (Fight 12)	With the guardians fallen, the ancient seal shatters	The towering Oni Gashadokuro rises from the cavern floor in a monumental 1-round survival clash.

LOCAL VERSUS & AI SKIRMISH

Head-to-head combat for 2 local players or player vs Artificial Intelligence. Features unrestricted selection across all 24 warriors, 24 thematic arenas, round configuration (1 to 5), and 3 selectable AI difficulty tiers (Easy, Normal, Hard).

THE THREE COMMANDMENTS OF DIEGETIC COMBAT

• 1. Maai (間合い - Métrica do Espaço): The art of millimetric spatial control. One step forward invites execution; one step back as the foe swings opens the fatal breach.

• 2. Mushin (無心 - Mente sem Hesitação): The intuitive state where reflex precedes calculation. Hesitation before the glint of enemy steel seals your burial.

• 3. Zanshin (残心 - Vigilância Contínua): Sustained alert awareness held even after landing a hit. Never drop your guard: foes may possess 3 HP or a dying reprisal.

SACRED DUEL SURVIVAL RULES

• Diegetic Lethality: No inflated health bars. The first clean counter-hit or whiff punish decides the round.

• Instant Ring-Out Pits: Across arenas like Ganryu Island, Iga Rooftops, and Dejima, being pushed over triggers instant ring-out death.

• Dynamic Soil Alchemy: The terrain beneath your sandals governs the draughts Hendrika can synthesize and Seimei's elemental resonances.

«Across the following pages (Pages 07 to 18), each dossier presents two champions and two home arenas in high technical density, detailing their physical metrics, authentic movesets, and true ground dynamics.»

KENSHI

The Twilight Battousai | 1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 5.40 m/s
Reach: Medium-Long (Frontal Quick-Draw)
Style: Hiten Mitsurugi-ryu (Swift Draw Iaijutsu & Battojutsu)
Lore: A scarred veteran of the early Kyoto skirmishes, Kenshi once wielded a blood-soaked blade until recognizing that innocent slaughter fed an ancient horror stirring beneath the soil. Forsaking all feudal masters, he swore to defend helpless villagers from the chaos of the Bakumatsu. His art relies on supreme drawing speed, deciding fatal duels in a single breath of razor-sharp stillness.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Iai Flash (Lightning Draw)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Blistering frontal quick-draw slash. Cleanly severs foes and bamboo thickets.
Special: Ryuu Tsui-Sen (Aerial Dive)	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Acrobatic aerial leap followed by a vertical diving slash that bisects the target.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: The Iai Flash boasts one of the fastest startups in the game (0.08s). During sheathing (Noto), Kenshi retains 60% movement speed. Ryuu Tsui-Sen grants airborne invulnerability frames, vaulting clean over bombs and ground traps.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Iai Flash has a strictly linear hitbox and requires a brief resheathing window. Flank Kenshi diagonally with agile evasions or exploit wide sweeping arcs (like Benkei's Naginata or Murasaki's Scythe) during his Noto recovery.

HOME ARENA: SACRED BAMBOO GROVE (ARASHIYAMA) — ARASHIYAMA, WESTERN OUTSKIRTS OF KYOTO (AUTUMN 1863)

Historical Context: The dense bamboo groves of Sagano and Arashiyama served as clandestine hideouts and escape corridors for imperial loyalists hunted by Shogunate forces. The constant rustlin...

Real Hazards & Pits: Zero environmental traps and zero ring-out pits. Pure neutral duel ground: bamboo stalks can be sliced by weapon strikes to clear open charge corridors.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Moist vegetal humus and rich black loam. Hendrika Gathering: Medicinal Roots and Plant Charcoal (Essential for Healing and Stamina draughts). Seimei: Pure Wood elemental resonance.

Spatial Tactics: Slice bamboo stalks with horizontal slashes to clear direct charge corridors. Exploit dense vegetation to deflect incoming arrows and rifle rounds. Pressure opponents toward cliff ledges for swift ring-out finishes.

MUSASHI

The Dual-Blade Sword Saint | 2. Peak Duelists & Glory Seekers

Health: 3 HP | Speed: 4.00 m/s
Reach: Medium (Katana Daito) & Short (Wakizashi Shoto)
Style: Niten Ichi-ryu (Two Swords as One Heaven)
Lore: Unbound by classical fencing dogma, Musashi wanders the Bakumatsu battlegrounds wielding a katana in his right hand and a wakizashi in his left. To his relentless spirit, the awakening of ancient horrors and mythical swordsmen represents the ultimate crucible to prove Niten Ichi-ryu as the supreme martial art in history.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Niten Double Slash	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Two-hit blade chain: downward katana cut followed by upward wakizashi riposte.
Special: Cross Counter Stance	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Immediate offensive parry: crosses dual blades and retaliates with an instantaneous fatal cross-slash.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Musashi boasts the highest counter-attack conversion rate in the game. His Cross Counter [R] absorbs frontal strikes and delivers an instant lethal riposte. The second swing of his normal chain features extended horizontal coverage.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Cross Counter only guards frontal angles. Never strike Musashi head-on when he stands still; flank behind him with rolling steps or deploy ranged artillery (Tomoe's Yumi, Hendrika's Flasks) to punish him outside reach.

HOME ARENA: DUEL ON GANRYU ISLAND (FUNAJIMA) — KANMON STRAIT, SETO INLAND SEA (MISTY DAWN)

Historical Context: The legendary sandbar island in the maritime strait where Miyamoto Musashi and Sasaki Kojiro fought history's most famous duel in 1612. During the Bakumatsu, the strait bec...

Real Hazards & Pits: 4 ring-out pits (deep ocean waters beyond the beach). Active hazard: periodic high-tide surges sweep across the sand, dragging combatants toward drowning boundaries.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Saline sea sand, crushed shells, and limestone silt. Hendrika Gathering: Refined Saltpeter and Brine Ash (Critical explosive reagent). Seimei: High Water elemental resonance.

Spatial Tactics: Vast, open shoreline favoring technical spacing and mid-range dueling. Dominate the central sand strip; fighters backed into the tidal surf suffer dodge deceleration and risk instant drowning knockouts.

HANZO

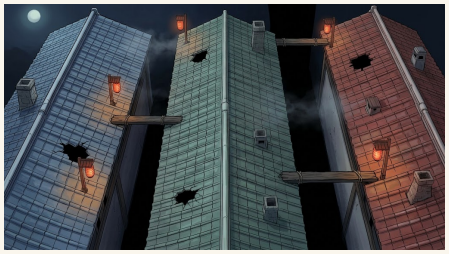
Grandmaster Shinobi of Iga | 6. Guardians of the Seal (Iga Shinobi Clan)

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.85 m/s (Hiper-Mobilidade)
Reach: Medium (Dark-Steel Ninjato) & Long (Sniper Kunai)
Style: Iga-ryu Ninjutsu (Hidden Blade & Aerial Acrobatics)
Lore: Supreme leader of the guardian shinobi, Hanzo knows the tale of Gashadokuro is no mere folklore, but an apocalyptic titan his clan has guarded for centuries. Protecting the Shadow Cave under the veil of night, he eliminates any trespasser nearing the seal, willingly bearing the stigma of a cold-blooded assassin to keep Japan safe.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Ninjato Slash	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Swift horizontal cleave with the straight Iga blade. Extremely short recovery window.
Special: Parabolic Leap & Kunai Snipe	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	High aerial vault clearing ground hazards while launching a pinpoint kunai mid-flight.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Parabolic Leap [R] grants full vertical immunity to ground swings and allows leaping across the widest chasms in Iga Rooftops. The kunai thrown at the apex stuns the target for 0.40s, setting up an unblockable descending execution.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Track Hanzo's trajectory during the Parabolic Leap. He suffers a 0.15s landing recovery window upon touching the ground. Anticipate his landing coordinates with a pre-emptive thrust.

HOME ARENA: NIGHT ROOFTOPS OF IGA — Shadow Castle, Mountainous Iga Province (Rainy Midnight)



Historical Context: The ancestral mountain stronghold of the Shinobi clans in the rugged heights of Iga Province. Engineered with steep ceramic-tiled roofs and sweeping eves designed to break ...

Real Hazards & Pits: 7 vertical ring-out drops (instant fatal falls off roof perimeters). Terracotta chimneys and ridge tiles provide solid obstacle cover.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Glazed ceramic tiles, aged chimney soot, and kiln clay. Hendrika Gathering: Dry Sulfur and Concentrated Soot (Crucial for Acid Bombs and Smoke Screens). Seimei: Strong Fire and Metal elemental affinity.

Spatial Tactics: Ring-out edge control is paramount. Fighters boasting high-recoil strikes (such as Hanzo and Musashi) can terminate rounds in under three seconds. Strictly avoid panic rolling toward outer corner diagonals.

JOE

The Time-Traveling Operator | 7. The Time Traveler & Unlikely Ally

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.80 m/s
Reach: Short (Combat Knife / Kunai) & Long (Doberman Hound Strike)
Style: Modern Special Tactics & Otaku Ninjutsu
Lore: A modern special forces operative and diehard ninja anime enthusiast, Joe was flung back to 19th-century Japan during a classified temporal experiment gone awry. Thrilled to experience authentic samurai warfare, he pledged loyalty to Hanzo's clan upon realizing the cataclysmic stakes of the Gashadokuro seal. Fights alongside his trained Doberman hound.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Windmill Shuriken	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Throws a colossal four-bladed windmill shuriken that cleanly decapitates foes.
Special: Yamato Dash	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Tactical command sending his doberman Yamato to tackle and pin the target.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Joe's Doberman acts as a living homing projectile. Upon connecting, the hound deals 1 damage and inflicts an 0.80s knockdown stun, allowing Joe to sprint in and execute the grounded foe with his tactical combat blade.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): The Doberman charges in a predictable straight trajectory. A wide horizontal cleave (such as Anne's Cutlass or Goro's Kuwa swing) swipes the hound aside mid-charge, leaving Joe completely exposed.

HOME ARENA: SECRET FOREST OUTPOST — Hidden Grove in the Iga Valleys (Overcast Dusk)

Historical Context: A camouflaged forward operating camp sheltered beneath ancient oaks where Joe established his sanctuary after being displaced across time. Modern military supply crates sit...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits and zero lethal traps. Central campfire dealing contact burn ticks and destructible wooden crates for ballistic cover.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Compacted dirt infused with campfire embers, fallen foliage, and stray gunpowder. Hendrika Gathering: Plant Charcoal and Coarse Black Powder. Seimei: Wood and Fire elemental synthesis.

Spatial Tactics: Use supply crates as ballistic cover against snipers and throwing stars. Herd opponents into the central fire pit to disrupt defensive stances and guarantee clean follow-up strikes.

SAITOU

The Lone Wolf of Mibu | 3. Loyalists & Order Keepers

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.45 m/s (Caminhada Predatória)
Reach: Long (Gatotsu Penetrating Charge)
Style: Mizo-ryu & Shinsengumi Kenjutsu (Left-Handed Lethal Gatotsu)
Lore: Captain of the Shinsengumi's 3rd Unit, Saitou embodies the ruthless code of 'Aku Soku Zan' (Slay Evil Immediately). A steadfast enforcer of law and order in Kyoto, he treats rebels and dark occultists alike as vermin to be impaled without mercy. His left-handed thrust is among the most lethal martial techniques of the Bakumatsu era.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Gatotsu Ishiki (Charging Thrust)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Left-handed piercing charge propelled with explosive speed, shattering loose guards.
Special: Gatotsu Zeroshiki (Point-Blank Crush)	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Zero-distance instant thrust without startup windup. Crushes parries and kills at point-blank.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Gatotsu Ishiki [E] spans nearly 4 meters of range with 14.0 m/s sprint acceleration. If the enemy turtles behind a parry, Zeroshiki [R] at point-blank range crushes the defense outright with an instant 1-Hit Kill.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Gatotsu travels in a strict linear line and sparks harmlessly off rocks, carts, or walls in Kyoto. Circle diagonally with side rolls and strike his exposed flank during thrust recovery.

HOME ARENA: KYOTO: BAKUMATSU IN FLAMES — SANJO DISTRICT, KYOTO (IKEDAYA INCIDENT, NIGHT OF 1864)

Historical Context: The ancient imperial capital engulfed in infernos during the Hamaguri Gate rebellion and the Shinsengumi's raid on the Ikedaya Inn. Aristocratic palanquins blaze amid cobbl...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Active hazards: speeding noble ox-carriages periodically barrel through the street trampling fighters, alongside falling burning debris and roof tiles.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Granite paving stones drenched in blood and burning embers. Hendrika Gathering: Gunpowder Sulfur and Fresh Blood Residue (Prime reagents for Poison and Acid vials). Seimei: Overwhelming Fire and Earth alignment.

Spatial Tactics: Dense urban corridor with straight sightlines ideal for Saitou's Gatotsu thrusts. Shove adversaries into the burning carriage wheels to trigger instant guard breaks and lethal openings.

TEPPO

The Tanegashima Marksman | 5. Mercenaries & War Corsairs

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.20 m/s (Caminhada Cadenciada com Arcabuz)
Reach: Infinite (Matchlock Shot) & Short (Oak Stock Strike)
Style: Hojutsu (Matchlock Gunnery & Tactical Artillery)
Lore: A seasoned marksman tempered in the wars between feudal clans, Teppo places no faith in myths or samurai honor codes: to his eyes, black powder is history's ultimate equalizer. Selling his deadly marksmanship to the highest bidder in the Bakumatsu, he scavenges powder horns from battlefields to ensure his heavy matchlock gun remains primed and lethal.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Lethal Matchlock Shot	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Deafening gunshot spanning the entire arena. 1-Hit Kill on connection. Consumes powder.
Special: Stock Strike / Reload	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Heavy strike with reinforced oak stock (knocks back and staggers) or reloads powder if pouches are collected.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: The Tanegashima bullet is unblockable along its line of fire by ordinary parries. His heavy stock strike [R] repels rushing foes and inflicts stun, granting the critical window needed to snatch powder horns scattered across the arena.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Never give Teppo breathing room to reload! Smother him with zig-zagging dashes and diagonal rolls from second zero. When unloaded, his combat range collapses entirely to point-blank stock bashes.

HOME ARENA: TRENCHES OF NAGASHINO — SHITARAGAHARA PLAINS, MIKAWA PROVINCE (MISTY DAWN)

Historical Context: The historic battlefield where synchronized Tanegashima matchlock volleys shattered the invincible Takeda cavalry in 1575, re-established during the Bakumatsu as a proving ...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Pointed wooden anti-cavalry palisades and deep mud trenches that reduce running movement speed.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Heavy rain-saturated clay, oxidized iron filings, and aged gunpowder silt. Hendrika Gathering: Crude Saltpeter and Iron Ore (Enhances explosive shrapnel damage). Seimei: Earth and Metal elemental balance.

Spatial Tactics: Control firing lanes between palisade rows to pin agile duelists. Funnel sprinting foes into deep mud to rob their dash momentum, leaving them open to long-range rifle volleys and bayonet lunges.

MURASAKI

The Shadow Sickle Kunoichi | 6. Guardians of the Seal (Iga Shinobi Clan)

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.65 m/s (Passo Sinuoso de Serpente)
Reach: Long (Iron Chain Link) & Medium (Curved Kama)
Style: Iga Kusarigamajutsu (Absolute Precedence Sickle)
Lore: Direct sentinel of the Shadow Cave threshold, Murasaki weaves iron chains through the dark to snare any warrior daring to disturb the Gashadokuro's crypt. Her curved sickle embodies Absolute Precedence: in simultaneous strikes, her scythe cuts first without entering weapon clash, claiming the rival's life in mid-motion.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Scythe Cleave (Absolute Priority)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Curved sickle arc boasting mathematical strike priority over simultaneous blows. 1-Hit Kill.
Special: Chain Throw & Harpoon Reel	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Hurls weighted iron chain up to 5.5m, dragging the staggered rival directly into striking range.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Murasaki's sickle bypasses weapon clashes entirely: in mutual strike frames, her blade lands first. Her chain throw [R] drags opponents across floor pits directly onto her lethal sickle tip.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Murasaki's chain requires significant travel and recovery time. If she whiffs the pull, she is frozen for 0.40s. Sidestep the projectile and punish her open flank.

HOME ARENA: SHADOW CAVE OF THE SEAL — SUBTERRANEAN DEEPS OF MOUNT SUZUKA, IGA BORDER (ETERNAL STYGIAN DARK)

Historical Context: A cavernous volcanic underworld where the founders of the Iga clan raised guardian monoliths and sacred Shimenawa ropes to seal the colossal skeletal remains of Oni Gashado...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Active hazard: massive swinging iron-chain pendulums and volcanic rocks sweeping through the cavern dealing blunt knockback.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Volcanic basalt, bioluminescent cave fungi, and cursed skeletal ash. Hendrika Gathering: Concentrated Miasma and Toxic Spores (Lethal Poison Vial brew). Seimei: Corrupted Earth and Shadow resonance.

Spatial Tactics: Exploit cave pillars to wrap curved kusarigama strikes around solid cover. Anchor fights near toxic gas vents to subject opponents to continuous health attrition while maintaining mid-range zoning.

KASUMI

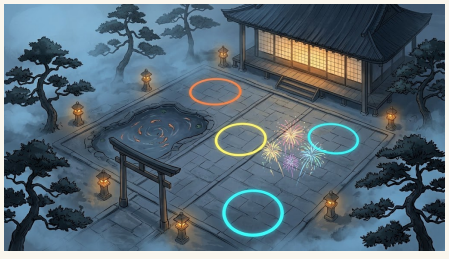
The Toxic Mist Kunoichi | 6. Guardians of the Seal (Iga Shinobi Clan)

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.75 m/s (Caminhada Silenciosa)
Reach: Short (Dual Ninjato) & Area (3D Arcing Bombs)
Style: Iga Hidden Mist (Chemical Bombs & Choking Smoke)
Lore: The most inventive sentinel of Iga, Kasumi protects the subterranean passages of the Shadow Cave utilizing chemical bombs and choking mists that disorient intruders. Knowing that bloodshed hastens the Gashadokuro's awakening, she neutralizes adversaries with toxic smoke screens before they can disturb the sacred seals.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Twin Ninjato Strike	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Snappy dual dagger cross-cleave for close quarters.
Special: 3D Arcing Chemical Bomb	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Hurls ceramic smoke orbs in a parabolic arc. Leaves dense choking poison mist that blinds and burns HP.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Kasumi can field up to 2 active chemical bombs concurrently. Lingering smoke clouds inflict severe slow and continuous damage to any enemy trapped within their haze for longer than 0.8s.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Never stand inside Kasumi's smoke clouds! Pressure her closely: if she attempts to throw a bomb at point-blank range, her throwing windup leaves her fully open to quick thrusts.

HOME ARENA: HIDDEN MIST TEMPLE — TENDAI MONASTERY IN THE HEIGHTS OF MOUNT HIEI (MORNING MIST)



Historical Context: An ancient Buddhist sanctuary perched upon the mist-shrouded crags of Mount Hiei, featuring polished cedar decking and translucent shoji screens. Amid the convulsions of th...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Active hazard: ceremonial firework mortar explosions detonating on the floor creating shockwaves and dense smoke screens.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Weathered cedar planks, highland moss, and ceremonial incense ash. Hendrika Gathering: Cedar Resin and Temple Incense Powder (Stamina regeneration draughts). Seimei: Wind and Water elemental harmony.

Spatial Tactics: Mist patterns favor stealth repositioning and high-agility dodge rolls. Slash open shoji walls to create flanking corridors and bait opponents toward exposed cliff drops behind shattered woodwork.

OKUNI

The Steel-Fan Kabuki Maiden | 4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.70 m/s (Danças Rítmicas Flutuantes)
Reach: Medium (Iron War Fan Tessen-jutsu)
Style: Kabuki Mai & Tessen-jutsu (Steel War Fans & Kawarimi Feint)
Lore: Mystical pioneer of Kabuki theatre along Kyoto's Kamo River. Under the guise of ceremonial performances, Okuni reaps spiritual fervor and crowd essence to empower her esoteric dances. She views the upheaval of the Bakumatsu as the ultimate stage to orchestrate Japan's grandest tragic performance.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Steel Fan Dance	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Twin iron war fan cleave embedded with razor-sharp steel tips beneath scarlet silk.
Special: Kawarimi Illusion Feint	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Vanishes in a swirl of sakura petals upon taking a hit, reappearing behind the attacker.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Kawarimi Feint [R] functions as an evasive illusion counter. If the enemy strikes during the feint window, Okuni instantly teleports behind them, inflicting a 0.60s disorientation stun.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): If Okuni miscalculates Kawarimi and no blow connects, she suffers an 0.35s whiff recovery stagger. Use delayed strikes and feints to punish her whenever the illusion fails to trigger.

HOME ARENA: FLOATING KABUKI STAGE — Dry Riverbed of the Kamo River, Shijo-Kawaramachi, Kyoto (Festive Dusk)

Historical Context: The historic birthplace of Kabuki theater founded by priestess Izumo no Okuni on the riverbanks of the Kamo River. Raised on pine stilts over flowing river waters, the hino...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Active hazard: the central mechanical rotating turntable shifts beneath fighters feet, continuously altering spatial alignment.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Polished Hinoki cypress planks and ceremonial white rice powder (Oshiroi). Hendrika Gathering: Alkaline Face Chalk and Noble Wood Rosin (Blinding smoke mixtures). Seimei: Vibrant Wood and Fire resonance.

Spatial Tactics: The compact square platform amplifies spatial danger. Sweep opponents toward the open water edges with wide fan arcs and spinning strikes to achieve sudden ring-out victories.

TOMOE

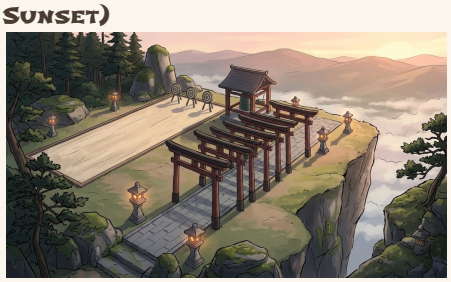
The Sacred Shrine Archer | 1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.40 m/s (Postura Serena)
Reach: Infinite (Yumi Longbow Arrow)
Style: Sacred Kyudo & Purifying Ofuda (Yumi Longbow)
Lore: Consecrated Miko of Mount Kurama Shrine north of Kyoto. Through divine visions, Tomoe witnessed the skeletal titan rising over the burning capital. She descended the sacred peaks armed with her Yumi longbow and sanctified arrows, sworn to fell the warlords whose slaughter weakens the Gashadokuro's divine seal.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Pinpoint Yumi Shot	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	High-velocity sanctified arrow traversing the entire arena in a straight trajectory. 1-Hit Kill.
Special: Sacred Arrow Volley (Sky Arc)	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Draws bow skyward, raining down 3 sanctified arrows in an arcing volley upon the enemy's coordinates.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Tomoe possesses unlimited arrows with a rapid 0.25s draw cycle. Her Sacred Volley [R] bypasses line-of-sight obstacles, striking targets hiding behind rocks, trees, or temple pillars.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): The Yumi bow requires a brief drawing windup. Close in via zig-zagging rolls timed to her arm lift. At point-blank range, Tomoe struggles to discharge arrows safely.

HOME ARENA: SACRED MOUNTAIN SHRINE — Spiritual Peak of Mount Kurama, North of Kyoto (Golden Sunset)



Historical Context: The ancient mountain shrine where, legend tells, Minamoto no Yoshitsune learned swordcraft from the Great Tengu. Rows of vermilion Torii gates lead to a flagstone courtyard...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits and zero lethal traps. Sacred vermilion Torii pillars and stone steps obstructing straight arrow volleys and lunges.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Sacred white gravel (Shirakawa-suna), mountain loam, and cedar needles. Hendrika Gathering: Purified Cinnabar and Camphor Crystals (Focus and Stamina enhancements). Seimei: Pure Heaven, Metal, and Wood alignment.

Spatial Tactics: Archetype playground for archers and marksmen. Interpose heavy Torii pillars between yourself and melee rushers, loosing charged arrows as they emerge from cover.

ANNE

The South Seas Corsair | 5. Mercenaries & War Corsairs

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.50 m/s (Passo Largo de Marinheira)
Reach: Medium-Wide (180° Cutlass Cleave)
Style: Naval Cutlass Fencing & Black Powder (Heavy Cleave)
Lore: Captain of a rogue corsair vessel anchored in Uraga Bay amidst the Bakumatsu arms smuggling boom. Anne bows to no emperor or shogun: her goal is plundering gold and military galleons to rule the open seas. Her naval fencing blends wide, bone-cracking cutlass sweeps with explosive bursts of black powder.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Cutlass Cleave (180° Sweep)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Massive horizontal 180-degree cleave. Impossible to evade laterally. Instant 1-Hit Kill.
Special: Powder Burst Lunge	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Ignites a powder charge at her feet, launching forward with an explosive cutlass charge.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Cutlass Cleave [E] commands the widest horizontal coverage in the roster: a full 180° hemisphere in front and flank. Her Powder Burst Lunge [R] blows through light projectiles while closing distance in a flash.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Anne's heavy cutlass carries an 0.28s post-swing recovery lag. Maintain mid-range and utilize precise piercing thrusts (like Julie's Rapier or Saitou's Gatotsu) to strike outside her perimeter.

HOME ARENA: PRIVATEER SHIP DECK — URAGA BAY, KANAGAWA COAST (NIGHT HIGH-SEAS GALE)

Historical Context: The iron-reinforced oak deck of the privateer frigate captained by Anne Bonny. Anchored near Uraga Bay where the American 'Black Ships' first forced Japan's opening in 1853...

Real Hazards & Pits: 5 ocean ring-out drops beyond the gunwales. Active hazard: violent gale-force ship rolling that forces combatants across the tilting deck.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Tarred teak planking, crusted sea salt, and naval flint grit. Hendrika Gathering: Maritime Pitch and Refined Saltpeter (Greatly expands bomb blast radiuses). Seimei: Tempestuous Water and Thunder affinity.

Spatial Tactics: Linear corridor geometry favors cutlass dashes and point-blank pistol volleys. Forcing adversaries over the low gunwales on the north or south flanks yields instant knockout ring-outs.

JULIE

The French Crown Musketeer | 3. Loyalists & Order Keepers

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.75 m/s (Passadas Nobres e Velozes)
Reach: Long (French Dueling Rapier)
Style: French Classical Fencing & Cloak & Dagger (Flèche & Riposte)
Lore: Elite guard officer sent with the French military and diplomatic mission in Yokohama to train modernized shogunate brigades. Proud and disciplined, Julie champions Western fencing as the pinnacle of military grace and speed. When ritualistic killings threaten the diplomatic enclave, she unsheathes her dueling rapier and swirling cape to defend her sovereign's honor.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Flèche Thrust (Lightning Lunge)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Aerodynamic straight-line dueling lunge with maximum arm extension. Clean 1-Hit Kill vital thrust.
Special: Cape Flourish & Acrobatic Kick	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Swirls her royal blue cape in a 360° blinding circle, delivering a stunning high equestrian kick.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Flèche Thrust [E] boasts the longest pinpoint reach among physical melee weapons (2.10m). Cape Flourish [R] interrupts rushing opponents, blinding them for 0.50s to guarantee a lethal fencing lunge.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Julie's Flèche operates along an exceptionally narrow beam (0.15m lateral width). Clean diagonal sidesteps bypass her tip entirely, leaving her flank wide open to swift counter-cleaves.

HOME ARENA: BAROQUE COURT OF THE FRENCH EMBASSY — EUROPEAN DIPLOMATIC ENCLAVE OF YOKOHAMA (GALA NIGHT OF 1865)

Historical Context: A classical French palace erected in the foreign treaty port settlement of newly opened Yokohama. Crystal chandeliers hang from frescoed ceilings, gilded marble colonnades ...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits and zero environmental traps. Grand hall featuring solid marble colonnades that absorb heavy swings and smooth waxed parquet flooring.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Waxed oak parquet and polished Carrara marble floor tiles. Hendrika Gathering: Refined Beeswax and Marble Dust (High-mobility agility draughts). Seimei: Noble Metal and Light element resonance.

Spatial Tactics: Pristine smooth flooring tailored for fencing footwork and blistering rapier lunges. Weave behind marble colonnades to absorb heavy club or broadsword swings before punishing during weapon recovery.

REN

The Iron-Fist Shaolin Monk | 2. Peak Duelists & Glory Seekers

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.65 m/s (Passos Rápidos e Firmes)
Reach: Short (Iron Fists) & Medium (Kiai Shockwave)
Style: Shaolin Quanfa & Spiritual Kiai Roar (Iron Strike)
Lore: A wandering monk forged in continental martial traditions who crossed the seas to Japan seeking enlightenment through combat. Ren disdains blades and steel weapons: his calloused iron knuckles shatter forged swords like dried twigs. He seeks duels against the most lethal masters to unlock the primordial spiritual force that shatters the illusion of fear.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Iron Fist Flurry	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Blistering 3-punch barrage. The concluding strike launches the enemy backward with lethal impact.
Special: Spiritual Kiai Roar	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Emits a 360° golden sonic shockwave that deflects projectiles and staggers all surrounding foes.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Spiritual Kiai Roar [R] shatters enemy parry guards within a 2.5-meter radius and reflects projectiles (arrows, kunais). His fists deliver relentless attack pressure, smothering opposing windups.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Ren is bound strictly to close-quarters combat. Keep him at bay using long-reach polearms (Aoi's Spear, Benkei's Naginata) or sustained projectile zoning to prevent him from closing the distance.

HOME ARENA: MOUNTAIN SHAOLIN TEMPLE — MASTERS COURTYARD, HIGH MONASTERY IN HENAN PROVINCE (MYSTIC CLOUD SEA)

Historical Context: The legendary training terrace of Shaolin warrior monks in the mist-crowned Songshan mountains. Flagstones bear deep depressions from centuries of iron-stance drills beside...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits and zero environmental traps. Sacred courtyard featuring stone Foo Dog guardian statues and bronze bells providing static cover.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Ancient chiseled granite, red highland clay, and lotus incense residue. Hendrika Gathering: Wild Mountain Ginseng and Myrrh Ash (Strength and Vitality draughts). Seimei: Harmonious balance of all Five Elements.

Spatial Tactics: Reward ground for close-quarters kung-fu and center-ring control. Use lightning-quick flying kicks and palm thrusts to pin foes against stone guardian statues before executing devastating aerial knockouts.

CHIYO

The Dual Kodachi Kunoichi | 6. Guardians of the Seal (Iga Shinobi Clan)

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.80 m/s
Reach: Short-Medium (Dual Kodachi 55cm Swords)
Style: Kodachi Nitoryu (Twin Kodachi & Mai Dance)
Lore: Master of the twin blade dance in the Iga clan. Unlike traditional assassins who rely on small daggers, Chiyo brandishes paired Kodachi short swords (55cm) with the graceful lightness of scarlet spider lilies. Her duty is patrolling the ancient perimeter of the Shadow Cave, cleaving intruders with lightning circular footwork and defensive spins.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Dual Kodachi Strike	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Lightning-fast strike with paired Kodachi short blades in a razor arc.
Special: Evasive Mai Dance	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Choreographic spinning dance with kodachis deflecting missiles and dazing close foes.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Chiyo wields twin matched Kodachi short swords (55cm blades). Her signature Mai Dance [R] creates a spinning blade whirlwind that deflects incoming kunai and arrows while repositioning.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Following the Crimson Vortex spin, Chiyo experiences an 0.30s dizziness recovery lag. Wait outside her spin perimeter and punish her instantly the moment her rotation ceases.

HOME ARENA: CRIMSON HIGANBANA MEADOWS — PLAINS OF ASUKA, YAMATO PROVINCE (CRIMSON DUSK)

Historical Context: Endless plains carpeted in crimson red spider lilies (Higanbana), the fabled blooms that flourish around cemeteries and guide departed souls across the River Sanzu into the...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits and zero traps. Open meadow carpeted by red spider lilies and ancient granite gravestones.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Dark graveyard earth saturated with toxic floral alkaloids. Hendrika Gathering: Higanbana Flower Bulbs and Paralytic Pollen (Prime ingredient for Stun and Neurotoxin brews). Seimei: High Soul and Wood occult resonance.

Spatial Tactics: The open field offers unrestricted freedom of movement. Control the center ring and use Chiyo's superior speed to flank opponents diagonally, evading wide slashes and punishing recoveries with rapid dual-blade cuts.

BENKEI

The Colossal Naginata Sohei | 1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

Health: 3 HP | Speed: 4.00 m/s (Passos Pesados e Implacáveis)
Reach: Colossal (2.5-Meter Giant Naginata)
Style: Sohei Kenjutsu (Heavy O-Yoroi Armor & Naginata)
Lore: The legendary warrior monk who swore to defend Gojo Bridge and Kyoto's sacred temples from tyrannical warlords. Clad in heavy iron-plated O-Yoroi armor and brandishing a colossal naginata, Benkei is a living fortress: boasting 3 HP, he withstands fatal strikes before falling, sweeping his massive glaive to shield pilgrims and the defenseless.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Colossal Naginata Sweep	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Gigantic sweeping arc spanning 2.5 meters. Deals crushing damage and sends opponents flying.
Special: Seismic Stomp & Roar	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Slams his armored foot into the floor, fracturing cobblestones and staggering nearby foes with a shockwave.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Benkei boasts 3 HP (highest in the roster) and heavy Poise: his colossal windups cannot be interrupted by light jabs. His naginata reaches targets at ranges no standard sword can contest.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Benkei is the slowest fighter in the roster (4.00 m/s) with significant recovery lag. Flank diagonally using agile skirmishers (Kenshi, Hanzo, Hendrika) and punish his exposed rear during weapon swings.

HOME ARENA: GOJO BRIDGE AT MIDNIGHT — Gojo Bridge over the Kamo River, Central Kyoto (Full Moon Midnight)

Historical Context: The famed ceremonial bridge of timber spans and stone pylons in the heart of Kyoto where the warrior monk Benkei defeated 999 samurai to claim their swords before meeting M...

Real Hazards & Pits: 2 instant-drowning ring-out drops into the deep Kamo River on both bridge edges. High-tension narrow ceremonial bridge corridor.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Massive oak timbers sealed with pitch and wrought-iron structural nails. Hendrika Gathering: Iron Filings and Oak Resin (Stone-skin Armor strengthening draughts). Seimei: Water and Metal alignment.

Spatial Tactics: Highest ring-out hazard density in the game. Heavy club knockbacks and linear charges effortlessly catapult adversaries into the river below. Strictly avoid rolling laterally near the fractured railings.

O-RIN

The Blind Shamisen Minstrel | 4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.45 m/s (Caminhada Suave Guiada pelo Som)
Reach: Infinite (Kamaitachi Sonic Blades)
Style: Oto-jutsu & Kamaitachi (Vacuum Soundwaves from Shamisen)
Lore: A blind minstrel wandering the lantern-lit alleys of Yoshiwara strumming her three-stringed shamisen. Behind her fragile facade lies an acoustic sorceress: her sharp musical chords tear the atmosphere, firing razor vacuum blades (Kamaitachi) that decapitate foes from afar. She feeds on the melancholy of fallen souls to tune her deadly instrument.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Kamaitachi Sonic Blade	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Plucks a sharp chord launching a razor-sharp vacuum blade traversing the entire arena. 1-Hit Kill.
Special: Resonant Fan Chord	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Fires 3 fan-shaped soundwaves that ricochet off walls, staggering anyone caught in their path.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Kamaitachi blades [E] fly at 16.0 m/s, piercing through destructible props and enemies. Her Resonant Fan Chord [R] saturates enclosed stages (such as Yoshiwara and Rain Mill) with dangerous ricochets.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): O-Rin is fragile and possesses no physical close-quarters blade. Use forward rolls [Space] to slip beneath the sonic waves and strike her at point-blank range where she cannot contest.

HOME ARENA: NIGHT ALLEY OF YOSHIWARA — Yoshiwara Pleasure Quarter, Edo (Night Cherry Blossom Rain)

Historical Context: The fabled walled courtesan quarter of Edo, glowing under hundreds of crimson paper lanterns and blooming sakura branches. Behind the glamorous facade of musical banquets a...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Claustrophobic urban alley bordered by wooden balconies and hanging laundry lines that obscure line of sight.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Moist Edo cobblestones, trampled sakura petals, and fragrant camellia grooming oil. Hendrika Gathering: Camellia Oil and Sakura Extract (High-speed mobility and stealth potions). Seimei: Water and Wood affinity.

Spatial Tactics: Claustrophobic quarters neutralizing long-range projectile zoning. Short-range dagger wielders and close-contact brawlers can pin adversaries against the wooden walls for inescapable corner traps.

GORO

The Peasant Rebel of the Kuwa | 1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.40 m/s (Passo Rústico e Pesado)
Reach: Medium-Long (Forged Iron Heavy Kuwa)
Style: Nogu-jutsu (Farming Implements & Raw Peasant Strength)
Lore: Leader of the Omi peasant rebellions, Goro grew sick of seeing harvests torched and farming families slaughtered by the squabbles of lords and samurai. He forged his heavy farming hoe (Kuwa) into an insurrectionist weapon of war. He fights alongside Kenshi and Benkei to ensure the blood of the poor does not fuel the Gashadokuro's resurrection.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Kuwa Earth Cleave	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Violent overhead slam with the heavy iron hoe. Shatters parries and pins the foe to the earth. 1-Hit Kill.
Special: Mud Stomp & Gravel Throw	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Stomps the soil hurling mud and sharp gravel into the enemy's eyes, blinding and staggering them.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: The Kuwa hoe combines blunt kinetic force with chopping cleaves: it shatters light parries automatically. Mud Stomp [R] slows down opponents by 40% across dirt and paddy fields.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Goro's Kuwa slam has high recovery lag if he misses the mark (0.32s). Roll sideways and strike his exposed back before he can dislodge the heavy iron hoe from the dirt.

HOME ARENA: RICE PADDIES AND IRRIGATION DYKES — RURAL TERRACES OF OMI PROVINCE (RAINY SUMMER AFTERNOON)

Historical Context: The ancestral agricultural wetlands that sustained rural populations and feeding feudal armies for centuries. Segmented by narrow earthen dykes and rushing irrigation sluic...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Raised dry earthen dykes bordered by submerged alluvial mud paddies that slow dodge rolls and sprint speed.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Saturated alluvial mud, decomposed rice straw, and mineral-rich fresh water. Hendrika Gathering: Agricultural Niter and Organic Sludge (Paralytic mud and caustic acid vials). Seimei: Pure Earth and Water resonance.

Spatial Tactics: Fight from the raised dry dykes to maintain crisp dodge recovery. Knock opponents into the submerged mud beds to rob their foot speed before executing heavy, unhurried sickle cleaves.

ICHI

The Blind Masseuse of the Cane Blade | 3. Loyalists & Order Keepers

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.60 m/s (Passo Silencioso com Bengala)
Reach: Medium (Reverse-Grip Shikomizue Cane)
Style: Gyaku-Iaijutsu (Concealed Cane Blade of the Masseuse)
Lore: Working as a blind traveling masseuse through the taverns and mills of Kyoto, Ichi harbors secret allegiance to loyalist peace magistrates. Beneath her meek, gentle demeanor, her walking cane conceals a razor-sharp steel blade. Her heightened hearing tracks the heartbeat and muscle twitches of assassins, executing them with reverse-grip draws.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Gyaku-Iai (Reverse Cane Draw)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Unsheathes the concealed blade in reverse grip with an upward lightning slash. 1-Hit Kill.
Special: Listening Trance Counter	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Stands motionlessly reading the wind: automatically evades incoming swings and counters with an unblockable thrust.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Listening Trance [R] is the most flawless counter-stance against predictable strikes. It requires no directional aiming: she slips and executes the attacker across a full 360-degree perimeter.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Never swing directly at Ichi when she stands still in Listening Trance! Use attack feints, ranged projectiles, or wait out the 0.50s trance duration to strike her during stance recovery.

HOME ARENA: MOUNTAIN RAIN MILL — HAKONE MOUNTAIN PASS, SAGAMI PROVINCE (TORRENTIAL CONTINUOUS DOWNPOUR)

Historical Context: An aged grain mill powered by a massive wooden waterwheel over a rushing cataract in the Hakone mountain pass. Under relentless autumn rain, the deafening roar of turning w...

Real Hazards & Pits: 2 fatal precipice drops down the rocky waterfall behind the mill. The massive wooden waterwheel churns continuously on the western flank.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Moss-slick pine decking, polished riverstones, and dense water mist. Hendrika Gathering: Aquatic Moss and Millstone Grit (Sensory focus and stamina recovery brews). Seimei: Overwhelming Water and Wind supremacy.

Spatial Tactics: Steer clear of the turning waterwheel unless setting up a throw into its crushing wooden paddles. Rely on straight, lightning-fast linear draws that punish opponents blinded by cascading rain.

VALERIUS

The Prussian Necromancer Diplomat | 4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.40 m/s (Passadas Sinistras e Nobres)
Reach: Long (Gothic War Scythe) & Undead Summoning
Style: Prussian Necromancy & Sepulchral Scythe Combat
Lore: Secret occult advisor attached to the Prussian embassy under the guise of commercial treaty negotiations. Valerius is a master of forbidden European necromancy: recognizing that the Bakumatsu harbors the dense concentration of agonizing souls in the world, he seeks to harness this death energy to crack the Gashadokuro's crypt and bind the titan to his macabre will.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Gothic Scythe Reaping	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Wide reaping sweep with his sepulchral war scythe. Long reach that shreds flesh and breaks light guards. 1-Hit Kill.
Special: Skeleton Minion Summon	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Rises an armed skeletal minion from the soil that relentlessly chases and harasses the opponent.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: The Skeleton Minion [R] functions as an active field ally: it absorbs an incoming blow or swings an ancient blade, creating the ideal distraction for Valerius to reap with his scythe.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Shatter the skeleton with a quick strike or circle diagonally outside the scythe's reach. Valerius suffers significant recovery lag after whiffing a heavy reaping swing.

HOME ARENA: GOTHIC PRUSSIAN CEMETERY — ANCESTRAL CRYPT IN THE SILESIAN FORESTS (ECLIPSE MIDNIGHT)

Historical Context: A centuries-old Gothic necropolis enclosed by wrought-iron fences and black granite mausoleums in Central Europe. Valerius, Prussian aristocrat and knight of the Black Orde...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Active hazard: spectral ground mist inducing temporary sluggishness in dark corners and jagged iron grave spires.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Frozen graveyard soil, pulverized skeletal bone dust, and oxidized iron ash. Hendrika Gathering: Corpse Dust and Black Ichors (Valyrian Hellfire and necrotic poisons). Seimei: Extreme Darkness and Nether affinity.

Spatial Tactics: Exploit the immense arc of the Prussian Zweihänder to herd foes toward iron cemetery gates. Pin enemies against stone crypts where heavy overhead cleaves shatter parry blocks and trigger fatal guard breaks.

SEIMEI

The Five-Element Onmyoji Maiden | 4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.60 m/s (Passos Flutuantes Místicos)
Reach: Infinite (6-Element Rondel Ofuda Talismans)
Style: Imperial Onmyodo & Elemental Talisman Magic (Heian Rondel)
Lore: Direct blood descendant of the legendary Abe no Seimei. Keeper of Heian's imperial cosmic scrolls, Seimei understands that the Gashadokuro is an ancient entity intertwined with the balance of Yin and Yang. Manipulating the 6-Element Rondel (Wood, Fire, Earth, Metal, Water, and Void), she channels incantations to reshape the Bakumatsu and bend the titan to her divine will.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Elemental Onmyodo Talisman	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Unleashes the active spell from the Rondel (Wood: rooting roots; Fire: guard-breaking blaze; Earth: crushing monolith; Metal: supersonic unblockable blade; Water: homing ricochet serpent; Void: control confusion).
Special: Rondel Element Cycle	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Rotates the mystical Rondel to the next element, tailoring incantations to counter opponent matchups.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Seimei ranks as the highest-winrate combatant in the global simulation (67.9% ~ 70.7%). Each element yields a unique tactical property: Wood (2s rooting), Fire (guard crush), Earth (knockdown monolith), Metal (100% unblockable at 32 m/s), Water (homing double ricochet), and Void (control inversion).
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Track Seimei's glowing aura and bottom Rondel icon to read her loaded element. Roll sideways against Wood needles and never attempt to parry the supersonic Metal blade.

HOME ARENA: HEIAN SHRINE OF ONMYODO — ASTRAL ALTAR OF SEIMEI-JINJA, IMPERIAL KYOTO (ASTRAL ECLIPSE MIDNIGHT)

Historical Context: The ancestral sanctuary established upon the estate of Abe no Seimei, paramount Onmyodo master of the imperial court. The holy courtyard features a colossal Pentagram Ronde...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Active hazard: elemental glyphs upon the Pentagram Rondel flare with mystic flares and shockwaves when charged by spells.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Ritual white marble, jade powder, and sanctified celestial sand. Hendrika Gathering: Alchemical Quicksilver and Mystic Saltpeter (Maximum Potency brews). Seimei: 100% elemental amplification for all Rondel spells.

Spatial Tactics: Dominate the courtyard geometry. Position inside the pentagram circle to accelerate spirit orb recharge. Use tessen fan gusts to blast short-range melee fighters onto active elemental floor glyphs.

DAIKI

The Bo Staff Pilgrim | 1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.60 m/s (Passadas Altas de Montanha)
Reach: Long (1.8m Oak Bo Staff)
Style: Yamabushi Mountain Pilgrim Bojutsu
Lore: Ascetic monk from the sacred mountains of Hida who descended into the lowlands after bandit gangs and deserters overrun ancient pilgrimage routes. Refusing to spill blood with edged steel blades, his seasoned oak Bo staff delivers crushing kinetic sweeps that disarm and incapacitate tyrants, shielding weary pilgrims with resolute serenity.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Swift Bo Sweep	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Rapid double-ended horizontal staff strike. Extended reach that staggers rival balance.
Special: Pole Vault Leap	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Plants the oak staff into the ground, vaulting skyward over chasms and descending with a crushing overhead blow.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Pole Vault Leap [R] clears wide floor gaps and evades ground traps, coming down with a crushing 1-Hit Kill impact over the heads of unprepared opponents.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Beware firing projectiles when Daiki is primed to leap. Track his landing coordinates and punish his brief 0.20s touchdown recovery lag.

HOME ARENA: SNOWY PINE FOREST — PILGRIMS PATH ON MOUNT KOYA (GLACIAL WINTER DAWN)

Historical Context: The sacred peak of Shingon Buddhism, blanketed under deep crystalline snow and five-hundred-year-old red pines. Frost-covered stone Toro lanterns mark the ancient pilgrim t...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Active hazard: deep snow drifts dampening sprint starts and heavy ice blocks dropping from aged pine boughs.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Frozen permafrost under virgin snow, red pine needles, and fossil amber resin. Hendrika Gathering: Pine Resin and Pure Frost Crystals (Chilling ice vials and Stamina brews). Seimei: Wood and Water/Ice affinity.

Spatial Tactics: The sweeping 360-degree reach of the oak staff dominates snowy clearings. Keep swordsmen at mid-range where the kinetic force of the wooden Bo shatters guard postures before they can step into katana cutting range.

AOI

The Ainu Huntress of Ezo | 1. Protectors of the People & Virtuous Ronin

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.70 m/s (Passadas Silenciosas na Neve)
Reach: Long (Traditional Ainu Op Spear)
Style: Ezo Hunting Mastery (Op Spear & Iron Bear Traps)
Lore: Huntress and protector of the indigenous Ainu people from the northern boreal wilderness of Ezo (Hokkaido). When ominous omens revealed that the sacred Kamuy mountain spirits were being corrupted by Kyoto's blood sacrifice, Aoi ventured south to hunt the horrors defiling the earth, armed with her carved Op hunting spear and spring-loaded bear traps.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Op Hunting Spear Thrust	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Crisp direct thrust with the carved Ainu spear. Outranges katanas with deadly piercing lethality. 1-Hit Kill.
Special: Plant Iron Bear Trap	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Conceals a spring-loaded toothed iron trap on the floor. Foes stepping upon it suffer bleed and 2.5s absolute root.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: The Iron Bear Trap [R] is nearly undetectable amidst battle chaos. Stepping on it completely immobilizes the foe for 2.5s, turning them into an effortless target for the Op spear thrust.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Watch the floor carefully to avoid stepping into Aoi's iron jaws! Vault or roll past the trap and punish her linear spear thrusts by flanking her sides.

HOME ARENA: WILD TAIGA OF EZO — PRIMEVAL WILDERNESS OF HOKKAIDO (ANCESTRAL AINU LANDS, DEEP WINTER)

Historical Context: The untamed primeval frontier of Japan's far north, prior to being renamed Hokkaido during the Meiji Restoration. Dense birch forests lashed by Arctic blizzards, prowled by...

Real Hazards & Pits: No ring-out pits. Active hazard: intermittent Arctic blizzard gusts altering arrow trajectories and fragile thin ice patches across the permafrost.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Glacial permafrost, reindeer lichen, and crushed antler silt. Hendrika Gathering: Arctic Lichen and Permanent Ice (Speed Draughts and Cryogenic Flasks). Seimei: Peak resonance with Water, Ice, and Wind.

Spatial Tactics: Use blizzard gusts to mask long-distance bow shots. Lure aggressively charging rushers onto thin ice fractures to cause chilling stumbles that guarantee lethal arrow follow-ups.

RAIDEN

The Undefeated Yokozuna of the Gods | 2. Peak Duelists & Glory Seekers

Health: 3 HP | Speed: 3.85 m/s
Reach: Medium (Harite / Tsuppari Palm Strikes) & Tachiai Tackle
Style: Sacred Shinto Sumo & Crushing Palm Thrusts (Tsuppari & Tachiai)
Lore: The greatest Yokozuna in Japanese history, whose sheer physical might is revered as a direct manifestation of the thunder kami. Raiden stepped into the sacred arena after challenging swordmasters who scoffed at unarmed combat. Boasting 3 HP and titanic Poise, his open-palm strikes shatter katanas and ribcages as if forged from parchment.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Tsuppari Combo (Seismic Sumo Palms)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Two-hit timed combo: Strike 1 (Harite stagger push) leading into Strike 2 (Morote-Tsuppari dealing 2 HP damage and crushing knockback).
Special: Tachiai Tackle (Homing Body Charge)	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Explosive full-body charge coated in heavy Poise. Shoves opponents across 4 meters and hurls them out of the ring.

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Raiden boasts 3 HP and full Poise during Tachiai Tackle [R]: incoming sword jabs cannot halt his momentum. The second strike of his Tsuppari chain [E] inflicts 2 flat damage, bowling over any rival caught standing.
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Never trade blows head-on against Raiden's armored palm charges or Tachiai tackle! His Poise will absorb your attack. Circle around using lateral dashes and punish his exposed flanks during tackle recovery.

HOME ARENA: SACRED DOHYO OF THE SHINTO SHRINE — GRAND SHRINE OF SUMIYOSHI TAISHA, OSAKA (CEREMONIAL DAWN)

Historical Context: The sacred clay ring (Dohyo) consecrated beneath a floating Shinto shrine-style roof canopy. Before becoming a sport, Sumo was a sacred Shinto ceremony performed to appease...

Real Hazards & Pits: No pits. Sacred hazard: the raised straw bale ring (Tawara). Stepping or being pushed outside the circular boundary triggers an immediate Ring-Out defeat!

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Consecrated Arakida clay compacted and cleansed with sacred ritual salt. Hendrika Gathering: Sanctified Purifying Salt and Shrine Earth (Resistance and Poison Neutralizing draughts). Seimei: Sacred Earth and Purity elemental alignment.

Spatial Tactics: The quintessential Ring-Out arena. Maintain absolute center-ring supremacy. Deploy Raiden's heavy open-palm slaps (Harite) and unstoppable body thrusts to drive challengers over the Tawara straw perimeter for instant victories.

HENDRIKA

The Tactical Dejima Alchemist | 4. Opportunists & Chaos Occultists

Health: 2 HP | Speed: 4.60 m/s (Passos Rápidos e Imprevisíveis)
Reach: Short (Caustic Guard-Crush Stiletto) & Area (5 Arcing 3D Flasks)
Style: Dutch VOC Alchemy (5 Chemical Reagents & Field Synthesis)
Lore: Brilliant Dutch scholar stationed at the VOC trading factory on the artificial island of Dejima in Nagasaki. Eccentric, calculating, and morally pragmatic, Hendrika treats the turmoil of the Bakumatsu as a sprawling open-air laboratory. She perfected a surgical stiletto coated in vitriol acid that dissolves enemy armor and five arcing chemical flasks, synthesizing lethal concoctions directly from the mineral composition of the soil beneath her boots.

Combat Action	Gamepad	Keyboard (P1 / P2)	Real Tactical Effect
Attack: Corrosive Stiletto (Guard Crush)	[X] / [Square]	[E] (P1) / [U] (P2)	Blistering acid-coated dagger thrust. If the enemy attempts to Parry, the stiletto shatters their posture (Guard Crush) inflicting instant stun.
Special: 3D Arcing Alchemical Flask	[Y] / [Triangle]	[R] (P1) / [I] (P2)	Hurls an arcing chemical vial leaving lingering hazard pools (Acid: corrosion; Fire: repulsion knockback; Ether: sleep stun; Frost: freeze slow; Miasma: control inversion).

• Weapon Dynamics & Gameplan: Hendrika's stiletto crushes parries outright with an 0.45s to 1.10s stun. Her chemical pools linger on the ground for up to 6.0 seconds. Standing 0.85s on any ground synthesizes that terrain's formula (Ice for Frost, Stone for Ether, Wood for Miasma, Soil for Acid). Remaining 2.0s on the same material elevates concoctions to Tier 2 (expanded 1.65m radius and boosted potency).
• How to Beat (Defense & Punishment): Steer completely clear of glowing chemical pools on the floor! Never attempt to parry Hendrika's stiletto. Utilize extended-reach weapons (Benkei's Naginata, Aoi's Spear, Tomoe's Bow) to strike her outside her short dagger range before she sets area traps.

HOME ARENA: DEJIMA WAREHOUSE WITH RAINY DOCK — DUTCH TRADING POST OF DEJIMA, PORT OF NAGASAKI (STORMY NIGHT OF 1866)

Historical Context: The fan-shaped artificial island in Nagasaki harbor that served for over two centuries as Japan's sole window of trade and scientific exchange (Rangaku) with the Western wo...

Real Hazards & Pits: 5 ring-out drops (southern dock edge directly over harbor waters). Active hazard: breakable alchemical glass carboys that leave caustic acid pools.

Soil & Alchemy: Soil: Salt-soaked pine dock planks stained with red lead, sulfuric acid residues, and imported elemental sulfur powder. Hendrika Gathering: Pure Sulfur, Fine Saltpeter, and Caustic Residues (The Alchemical Paradise: gathering speed boosted by 30%!). Seimei: Corrosive Water, Metal, and Fire elemental blend.

Spatial Tactics: Tactical haven for alchemists and fencing specialists. Deliberately shatter reagent carboys to lay down acid zones that disintegrate enemy poise. Utilize swift rapier lunges to herd overeager brawlers off the wet dock into the harbor.

THE FORBIDDEN AWAKENING — FINAL BOSS

ONI GASHADOKURO (鬼餓・餓者髑髏) — The Skeletal Titan Forged from the Malice of Ten Thousand Unburied Souls

Legend of the Slumbering Colossus:

Within the unfathomable depths of the Shadow Cave in Iga, beyond forgotten altars and sacred Shimenawa talismans, slumbers feudal Japan's most horrifying secret. The Gashadokuro is no mere demon: it is a primeval cataclysm, a towering colossus formed from the fused bones of all warriors, peasants, and innocents slaughtered in wars from the Sengoku era to the twilight of the Bakumatsu. The Iga Guardians (Hanzo, Kasumi, Murasaki, Chiyo, and Joe) dedicated their lives to turning back every intruder to keep the ground calm. But when the twelve duels of the Arcade ladder culminate and the spilled blood of elite champions seeps into the bedrock, the mystical seals rupture with a thunderous roar. A pair of burning crimson eyes ignites in the dark, and a massive skeletal hand armed with iron claws rises from the earth to purge the realm of the living.

The Three Combat Phases:

• Fase 1: Punho Esmagador & Clava Titânica: The Titan boasts complete frontal hyper-armor. Seismic fist slams fracture bedrock, triggering jagged stalactite collapses across the entire battlefield.

• Fase 2: Cortina de Miasma & Névoa Venenosa: Upon losing initial spiritual vigor, the colossus exhales toxic miasma and violet soulfire along cavern perimeters, penning the player into the central circle.

• Fase 3: Queda na Borda & Janela da Gema: Following a three-hit cataclysmic sequence, the Titan collapses in exhaustion for 1.8s, resting its skull upon the pit edge. This is your sole opening to deliver the fatal coup de grâce to the forehead gem.

IRONCLAD RULE OF THE FINAL CLASH (SINGLE-ROUND SUDDEN DEATH):
There is no Best-of-3 against the Oni Gashadokuro. A single misjudged roll or distance error results in instant obliteration. Maintain perfect calm (Mushin) and strike solely when the titan's skull rests exhausted upon the precipice.

RECOMMENDED STRATEGIES BY MARTIAL ARCHETYPE

• Espadachins Rápidos & Assassinos (Kenshi, Saitou, Chiyo, Julie, Kasumi): Utilize dedicated roll [T] to slip beneath seismic club arcs. Hold mid-range diagonally and strike with primary attack [E] the instant the skull rests upon the pit edge.

• Colossos & Combatentes Pesados (Raiden, Benkei, Valerius, Goro): Your 3 HP pool and hyper-armor weather falling rock debris. Charge heavy Guard Crush strikes to inflict devastating impact upon the forehead gem during Phase 3 exhaustion.

• Zoners & Atiradores de Pólvora/Magia (Teppo, Hanzo, Seimei, Tomoe, Hendrika): Maintain continuous ranged pressure to accelerate Phase 2 miasma depletion. When the titan collapses, sprint in instantly to land the decisive melee cut on the grounded head.

TECHNICAL APPENDIX & COMBAT DIRECTIVES

OVERALL PERFORMANCE TABLE & WINRATES (6,624 SIMULATED COMBATS)

Data compiled from official automated tournament simulations under symmetric arena rotations (Sacred Dohyo, Iga Rooftops, Ganryu Island, and Burning Kyoto) against NORMAL level AI:

Rank	Fighter	Archetype / Primary Weapon	Wins	Losses	Winrate	Tier
1	Seimei	Talisman Onmyoji (Ofuda / Pentagram Rondel)	125	51	67.9%	Tier S
2	Teppo	Gunpowder Marksman (Tanegashima / Bayonet)	116	66	63.0%	Tier S
3	Hanzo	Iga Shinobi Grandmaster (Kunai / Tactical Draw)	115	69	62.5%	Tier S
4	Saitou	Wolf of Mibu (Shinsengumi / Gatotsu)	115	68	62.5%	Tier S
5	Hendrika	Dejima Alchemist (Rapier / 5 Chemical Flasks)	109	74	59.2%	Tier S
6	Joe	Tactical American Ninja (Shuriken / Rifle / Doberman)	108	76	58.7%	Tier S
7	Kenshi	Twilight Battosai (Hiten Iaijutsu / Shukuchi)	107	76	58.1%	Tier S
8	Tomoe	Sacred Miko Archer (Longbow Yumi / Spirit Arrow)	107	77	58.1%	Tier S
9	Murasaki	Shadow Kunoichi (Venomous Kusarigama)	93	90	50.5%	Tier B
10	Valerius	Prussian Necromancer (Zweihänder / Dark Flames)	93	91	50.5%	Tier B
11	Ichi	Blind Blade (Shikomizue / Reverse Gyaku-Iai)	92	90	50.0%	Tier B
12	Musashi	Dual Blade Kensei (Niten Ichi-ryu / Twin Blades)	87	96	47.3%	Tier B
13	Kasumi	Mist Kunoichi (Ninja-to / Smoke Bombs)	87	96	47.3%	Tier B
14	Aoi	Wild Ainu Huntress (Horn Bow / Nordic Makiri)	87	97	47.3%	Tier B
15	Chiyo	Blade Dancer (Dual Higanbana Kodachi Whirlwind)	82	102	44.6%	Tier C
16	Daiki	Bo Staff Pilgrim (Oak Bo / Pole Vault)	81	103	44.0%	Tier C
17	Goro	Rebel Farmer (Kuwa Mattock / Seismic Stomp)	80	103	43.5%	Tier C
18	Anne	Corsair Captain (180° Cutlass / Flintlock Pistol)	78	105	42.4%	Tier C
19	Julie	Royal Musketeer (French Rapier / Precise Riposte)	77	107	41.9%	Tier D
20	Ren	Shaolin Fist Monk (Iron Palm / Flurry Kick)	76	107	41.3%	Tier D
21	O-Rin	Yoshiwara Minstrel (Razor Shamisen / Concealed Dagger)	74	105	40.2%	Tier D
22	Okuni	Kabuki Priestess (Iron Tessen Fan / Miasma)	70	113	38.0%	Tier D
23	Raiden	Undefeated Yokozuna (Heavy Tsuppari / Tachiai Charge)	68	111	37.0%	Tier D
24	Benkei	Sohei Warrior Monk (Iron Kanabo / Colossal Naginata)	64	118	34.8%	Tier D

BALANCE ANALYSIS & DIEGETIC METAGAME

• Tier S (Winrate > 58% — Neutral Control): Seimei, Teppo, Hanzo, Saitou, Hendrika, Joe, Kenshi, and Tomoe lead automated bouts by leveraging projectile zoning and space-denial tools before melee engagement.

• Tier B (Winrate 47%–50% — Versatile Anti-Meta): Murasaki, Valerius, Ichi, Musashi, Kasumi, and Aoi combine lethal parry counters, smoke evasion, and solid mid-range combat lethality.

• Tier C & D (Heavy Colossi in Human Hands): Heavyweights like Raiden and Benkei record lower automated AI winrates due to substantial recovery frames. In the hands of skilled human players, their 3 HP life pool, hyper-armor, and Guard Crush strikes turn a single enemy misstep into instant fatality.

ABSOLUTE PRECEDENCE & PRIORITY DIRECTIVE

BLADE CLASH MATHEMATICS & INITIATIVE FRAMES

In Samurai Edge, attacks are resolved across 4 strict mathematical priority layers. When two combatants swing within the same spatial verification tick, the engine applies the following resolution order:

Layer	Impact Classification	Notable Examples	Collision Outcome
Tier 4	Absolute Precedence	Murasaki Kusarigama, Hendrika Rapier	Guaranteed sever. Bypasses clashes and interrupts any rival swing.
Tier 3	Guard Crush Heavy	Teppo Bayonet, Benkei Kanabo, Raiden Stomp	Shatters active parry stances, applying heavy daze and stun.
Tier 2	Symmetric Clash	Katanas of Kenshi, Musashi, Saitou, Chiyo, Julie	Freezes time for 600ms and triggers the rapid-mash QTE micro-contest.
Tier 1	Projectiles & Light	Shurikens, thrown Kunai, unarmed jabs	Deflected effortlessly by any active parry stance or sword cut.

3D HITBOX ANATOMY & ISOMETRIC COLLISION ENGINE

• Oriented Voxel Boxes (mk.obox): Weapon and limb collision volumes rotate dynamically through 3D space according to advance vectors (rx, ry) and elevation (z), ensuring flawless mathematical verification across full 360-degree angles.

• Back-Face Culling & Winding Order: All collision face sets point strictly outward, eliminating any risk of weapon swings becoming intangible or culled when viewed from profile camera angles (90° / 270°).

Weapon Class	Startup	Active Frames	Whiff Recovery	Tactical Exposure
Daggers & Kodachis	0.08s (5f)	0.06s (4f)	0.12s (7f)	Low Risk. Rapid guard recovery denies whiff punishes.
Katanas & Medium Blades	0.12s (7f)	0.08s (5f)	0.20s (12f)	Moderate. Punishable by forward lunges upon whiffing.
Bo Staffs & Naginatas	0.16s (10f)	0.12s (7f)	0.28s (17f)	High Risk. Sidestep roll guarantees clean counter-decapitation.
Colossal Kanabo / Clubs	0.24s (14f)	0.14s (8f)	0.42s (25f)	Critical Risk. Heavy ground lag invites fatal retribution.

ADVANCED CLASH, PUNISHMENT & SPATIAL CONTROL

• Resolução do Choque de Lâminas (Blade Clash QTE): The duelist overpowered in the rapid-mash contest suffers 24 frames of off-balance stagger, remaining completely defenseless against a decisive follow-up execution.

• A Regra de Ouro do Rolamento Evasivo: The dedicated dodge roll [T] confers 12 frames of invulnerability to horizontal slashes and projectiles. However, downward-plunging strikes track prone bodies, punishing panic rolls mercilessly.

• Janelas de Recuperação & Punição Fatal (Whiff Punish): Massive weapons carry vulnerable recovery windows between 0.20s and 0.42s. Back-stepping and lunging immediately punishes any strike that whiffs in the air with clean decapitation.

«On the path of the blade, steel tells no falsehood: he who calculates initiative frames commands fate; he who swings into the empty air forfeits his own skull.»

SOIL REAGENTS & CLANDESTINE ALCHEMY DIRECTIVE (HENDRIKA & SEIMEI)

NATURAL REAGENTS & RONDEL ELEMENTS DIRECTIVE

Hendrika synthesizes combat flasks in real time by gathering minerals and herbs from the arena floor. The table below details biome properties and unique benefits conferred upon alchemical brews and Onmyodo spells:

Biome / Arenas	Harvestable Reagents	Synthesized Draughts	Environmental Perk
Dejima Warehouse / Harbors	Pure Sulfur, Fine Saltpeter, Acid Residues	Acid Flask (Guard Crush) & Alchemical Fire	+30% flask gathering speed
Burning Kyoto / City Streets	Fresh Blood, Fire Soot, Black Powder	Lethal Venom Brew & Incendiary Grenade	Resistance to ticking fire damage
Forests / Red Pines / Taiga	Medicinal Roots, Pine Sap, Natural Resin	HP Restoration Elixir & Max Stamina Tonic	Faster roll recovery frames
Graveyards / Shadow Cave	Corpse Dust, Fungal Miasma, Dark Ash	Blinding Smokescreen & Paralytic Neurotoxin	Slows enemy movement speed
Shrines / Sacred Dohyo	Consecrated Salt, Camphor, Star Sand	Iron Armor Potion & Focus Elixir	Cancels active venom and bleeding
Asuka Plains / Rice Fields	Fine Clay, Spring Water, Bamboo Shoots	Fortifying Balm & Camouflage Mist	Boosts dash lunging distance
Silesian Crypts / Enclave	Molten Silver, Flint Oil, Crude Saltpeter	Purifying Flame Flask & Royal Acid	Amplifies counter-hit stun duration

HENDRIKA'S COMBAT FLASK CATALOG:

- Acid Draught: Sulfur + Acid. Corrosive rapier lunge that shatters parry stances (Guard Crush).
- Alchemical Fire: Saltpeter + Powder. Thrown concoction creating blast knockback and burn ticks.
- Soporific Ether: Roots + Resin. Tranquilizer puddle sapping stamina and preventing sprints.
- Cryogenic Saltpeter: Freezing frost cloud delaying enemy swing recovery frames by 40%.
- Confusion Miasma: Fungal spores temporarily reversing opponent directional inputs.

SEIMEI'S FIVE ELEMENTS (ONMYODO):

- Wood: Entangling root traps and amplified homing curvature across forest grounds.
- Fire: Fan-shaped firewalls and rapid ticking burn damage on burning Kyoto alleys.
- Earth: Stalagmite barricades and shockwave absorption across Asuka paddies.
- Metal: Passive projectile deflection and razor talismans at Dejima and the court.
- Water: Blinding fog screens and high-pressure hydraulic waves on Ganryu shorelines.

TACTICAL HARVEST & PENTAGRAM RONDEL CYCLE DIRECTIVE

- Satchel Capacity & Neutral Gathering: Hendrika holds up to 3 synthesized draughts; harvesting ground reagents in neutral stance requires 0.45s of stillness. Enemy hits during gathering cancel synthesis.
- Onmyodo Pentagram Resonance: Wood feeds Fire; Fire creates Earth; Earth yields Metal; Metal attracts Water; Water nourishes Wood. Casting spells in cycle reduces stamina cost by 25%.
- Soil Affinity Boost: Engaging on matching terrain biomes amplifies projectile velocity and elemental dispersal radius.

«The earth beneath your sandals is no ordinary soil: it is the living crucible and ancestral shrine whence spring both lethal venom and the elixir of triumph.»

MARTIAL GLOSSARY & SAMURAI COMBAT TERMS

HISTORICAL CONCEPTS & DISCIPLINE OF BAKUMATSU STEEL

I. Philosophy of the Blade & Martial Conduct:

- Iaijutsu (居合術): The classical martial art of drawing the sword and cutting in a single continuous motion, mastered to perfection by Kenshi.
- Noto (納刀): The ceremonial act of sheathing the blade following a slash. In-game, this represents Kenshi's vulnerable whiff recovery window.
- Maai (間合い): The spatial combat engagement distance between two duelists. Encompasses both physical reach and the time required to strike.
- Mushin (無心): 'Mind without mind'. A state of pure spontaneous focus where the martial artist acts upon instinct without conscious pause.
- Zanshin (残心): 'Remaining mind'. Sustained alert awareness maintained following a strike to deny any counter-offensive surprises.
- Katsujinken (活人剣): The life-giving sword. The moral doctrine of the Protectors of the People who wield steel to shield innocents from tyrants.
- Setsuninto (殺人刀): The life-taking sword. The doctrine of merciless killers who view the blade purely as an instrument of slaughter and dominance.
- Sen-no-sen (先の先): Seizing absolute initiative: sensing hostile intent and cutting at the precise split-second the adversary commits to their advance.
- Go-no-sen (後の先): Reactive counter-strike: baiting an enemy into whiffing in the air, then executing them during their recovery lag.
- Fudoshin (不動心): 'Unshakable mind'. Imperturbable serenity in the face of imminent death or psychological provocations.
- Shisei (姿勢): Physical posture and balance of one's center of gravity, facilitating seamless transitions between sprints, rolls, and strikes.
- Kiai (気合): The concentrated projection of spiritual energy and breath upon the point of impact to maximize cutting force.

II. Traditional Weapons, Tactics & Folklore:

- Zanzou (残像): Visual afterimage left behind by hypersonic martial displacement, seen in Kenshi's Shukuchi Dash and Kasumi's steps.
- Kodachi (小太刀): Japanese short sword with a blade length between 50 and 60 cm. Dual-wielded by Chiyo for rapid slashes and deflections.
- Kanabo (金砕棒): Heavy octagonal war club studded with iron spikes, wielded with crushing momentum by the warrior monk Benkei.
- Tsuppari (突っ張り): Rapid open-palm thrusts employed by Sumo rikishi like Raiden to break guard stances and drive opponents out of the ring.
- Rangaku (蘭学): 'Dutch Learning'. The body of Western scientific, alchemical, and medical treatises studied clandestinely by Hendrika.
- Onmyodo (陰陽道): Traditional Japanese esoteric cosmology based upon the five elemental phases wielded by Abe no Seimei.
- Gashadokuro (餓者髑髏): Colossal skeletal titan forged from the collective malice of thousands of warriors abandoned without grave in ancient wars.
- Sakoku (鎖国): The two-and-a-half centuries of strict maritime isolation imposed by the Shogunate, shattered by the dawn of the Bakumatsu.
- Tanegashima (種子島): Classical matchlock arquebus introduced to Japan in 1543, mastered with deadly precision by marksman Teppo.
- Shikomizue (仕込み杖): Concealed blade disguised within an unassuming wooden walking stick, wielded with deadly speed by blind master Ichi.
- Shimenawa (注連縄): Sacred braided rice-straw cord hung across Shinto shrines and sumo dohyos to ward off evil spirits and purify holy ground.
- Bokken (木剣): Solid oak practice katana utilized in classical dojos to temper martial discipline and reflex without lethal bloodshed.

III. Three Cardinal Virtues of the Diegetic Duelist

- Giri (Duty & Honor): Unconditional reverence toward the adversary's blade; every encounter is a sacred dialogue of poise and skill.
- Meiyo (Unyielding Poise): Remaining resolute within engagement range, rejecting dishonorable panic retreats or infinite evasions.
- Makoto (Absolute Truth): Executing every cut with irrevocable commitment: the drawn edge manifests the warrior's spirit.

«He who grasps the ancient words grasps the blade itself. Steel is merely an extension of will; when the mind is pure, the strike is invincible.»

SAMURAI EDGE: BAKUMATSU

BAKUMATSU COMBAT — TECHNICAL COLOPHON & CREDITS

CREDITS & CONTRIBUTORS

Game Designer, Songwriter, Artist:	Colletes
Development Toolset:	Gemini / Antigravity, Suno, Google Flow
Community Supporters:	itchzaya, Tiago Fraga, Tobias C.
Dedication:	To Lorena. Always to Lorena, who supports me in my madness.

TECHNICAL ENGINE SPECIFICATIONS

- Framerate & Resolution: Rock-solid 60 FPS at native 1920x1080 Full HD featuring diegetic isometric projection.
- 3D Visual Architecture: Low-Poly faceted geometry inspired by the PS1 golden era (Tekken 2/3), strictly free of flat 2D decals.
- Vector Collision Simulation: True 3D weapon blade detection via dynamically oriented voxel bounding boxes (mk.obox).
- Acoustic Folk Soundscapes: Authentic traditional instrumentation (taiko, shakuhachi, shamisen, biwa, and koto) without vocals.

PRODUCTION DEDICATION: Inspired by the great masterworks and manga of Feudal Japan.

身はたとひ
武蔵の野辺に
朽ちぬとも
留め置かまし
大和魂

— Yoshida Shōin (吉田松陰) —

«Even should my body
Upon the plains of Musashi
Decay and turn to dust,
I shall leave behind
The Japanese soul.»

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